

Day 18 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Age of Vijayanagaram and Bahmani Kingdoms; South Indian History

READING MATERIAL

Third topic of Unit III, combining medieval Deccan kingdoms with ancient/medieval South Indian (Sangam-age and Chola) history. Real exam evidence shows a strong South-Indian-history lean with a classic trap format: swapping two kingdoms' correct facts between each other as wrong-answer bait.

Q: Real exam (trap format): Match each king/dynasty to its correct capital pair — Chera King, Chola King, Pandiya King, King Ashoka. Which pairings are correct: Chera-Vanji/Thondi, Chola-Madurai/Korkai, Pandiya-Uraiyur/Poombugar, Ashoka-Samba Inscription?

A: Only Chera-Vanji/Thondi and Ashoka-Samba Inscription are correct. The Chola and Pandya pairings are SWAPPED in the trap: actually, Chola's capitals were Uraiyur and Poompuhar (not Madurai-Korkai), and the Pandya capitals were Madurai and Korkai (not Uraiyur-Poombugar). Always double check which Tamil dynasty owned which historic capital pair — this exact swap is a recurring trap.

Q: Real exam: Which inscription/plate exposed that the Chola Queen Vanamadevi committed Sati?

A: The Anbil Plate.

Q: Real exam: During the Later Chola period, what was 'Irayili'?

A: Tax-free land (not taxed land, temple-leviable tax, or leasing-land tax).

Q: Real exam: What was the Chola kingdom's revenue department called?

A: Puravuvuri (not Perumtharam, Utan Kuttam, or Olai Nayagam).

Q: Real exam: Arrange these Sangam-age Chera kings chronologically — Senkuttuvan, Emayavaramban, Kanaikal Irumporai, Kuttuvan Cheral.

A: Emayavaramban → Senkuttuvan → Kuttuvan Cheral → Kanaikal Irumporai.

Q: When was the Vijayanagar Empire founded, by whom, and what dynasties ruled it?

A: Founded in 1336 by brothers Harihara I and Bukka Raya I, of the Sangama dynasty. Four dynasties ruled it over time: Sangama, Saluva, Tuluva, and Aravidu.

Q: Who was Krishnadevaraya, and what were his key achievements?

A: The greatest Vijayanagar king, of the Tuluva dynasty, ruled 1509-1529. He extended the empire across most of South India, defeated the Bahmani Sultans and Portuguese, captured Bahmani forts (Bidar, Gulbarga, Raichur, Bijapur), made major temple donations (adding towering gopuras), and authored the Telugu poem Amuktamalyada (the story of Andal).

Q: Who founded the Bahmani Kingdom?

A: Alauddin Hasan, an Afghan officer under Muhammad bin Tughlaq, who took the title Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah.

Q: What was the long-running cause of conflict between Vijayanagar and the Bahmani Kingdom?

A: A dispute over the Raichur Doab — the fertile region between the Krishna and Tungabhadra rivers (also extending to disputes over the Krishna-Godavari delta).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Which inscription/plate exposed that the Chola Queen Vanamadevi committed Sati?

A. Tiruvalangadu Plate

B. Anbil Plate ✓

C. Velvikudi Plate

D. Bahur Plate

Explanation: Anbil Plate. [hard, question-bank-2025]

2. Which dynasty's historic capitals were Madurai and Korkai?

A. Chera

B. Chola

C. Pandya ✓

D. None of these

Explanation: Pandya — a common trap swaps this with Chola. [medium, question-bank-2026]

3. Which dynasty's historic capitals were Uraiyr and Poompohar?

A. Chera

B. Chola ✓

C. Pandya

D. Pallava

Explanation: Chola — a common trap swaps this with Pandya. [medium, question-bank-2026]

4. During the Later Chola period, 'Irayili' referred to:

A. Taxed land

B. Tax-free land ✓

C. Temple-leviable tax

D. Leasing-land tax

Explanation: Tax-free land. [medium, question-bank-2022]

5. The Chola kingdom's revenue department was called:

A. Perumtharam

B. Utan Kuttam

C. Puravuvuri ✓

D. Olai Nayagam

Explanation: Puravuvuri. [hard, question-bank-2017]

6. The Vijayanagar Empire was founded in 1336 by which brothers?

A. Harihara I and Bukka Raya I ✓

B. Krishnadevaraya and Achyuta Raya

C. Saluva Narasimha and Tuluva Narasa

D. Rama Raya and Tirumala

Explanation: Harihara I and Bukka Raya I, of the Sangama dynasty. [medium, web-research]

7. Krishnadevaraya, the greatest Vijayanagar king, belonged to which dynasty?

A. Sangama

B. Saluva

C. Tuluva ✓

D. Aravidu

Explanation: Tuluva dynasty. [medium, web-research]

8. The long-running Vijayanagar-Bahmani conflict was mainly over control of:

A. The Raichur Doab ✓

B. The Deccan plateau entirely

C. Goa's ports

D. The Coromandel coast

Explanation: The Raichur Doab, between the Krishna and Tungabhadra rivers. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Percentage

READING MATERIAL

Percentage is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. TNPSC's percentage questions are built from a handful of recurring shapes — successive discounts, reverse percentage ('20% of $x = 50$, find x '), percentage of a mixture, and percentage of a time period — recognize the shape first, then compute.

Q: Method — successive percentage discounts: A TV was sold for ₹14,400 after successive discounts of 10% and 20%. What was its original (market) price?

A: Successive discounts don't add (it's NOT a flat 30% off) — apply them one after another. If the market price is P : $P \times 0.90 \times 0.80 = 14,400 \rightarrow P \times 0.72 = 14,400 \rightarrow P = 14,400 / 0.72 = ₹20,000$.

Q: Method — percentage of a mixture (the parts must add to 100%): An alloy is 30% copper and 40% zinc, rest nickel. Find the nickel in 20 kg of the alloy.

A: Nickel % = $100 - 30 - 40 = 30\%$. Nickel amount = 30% of 20 kg = 6 kg. The key step is realizing the percentages must total 100% — nickel is whatever's left over, not a number given directly.

Q: Method — reverse percentage ('find the whole, given a percentage of it'): If 20% of $x = 50$, find x .

A: 20% of $x = 50 \rightarrow 0.20 \times x = 50 \rightarrow x = 50 / 0.20 = 250$. Reverse-percentage questions give you the part and the percentage, and ask for the whole — divide, don't multiply.

Q: Method — percentage of a decimal/small number: Find 0.75% of 40 kg.

A: $0.75\% = 0.0075$. $0.0075 \times 40 = 0.3$ kg. Common mistake: treating '0.75%' as '0.75' (i.e. 75%) instead of converting the decimal percentage properly — always convert to a decimal fraction first (divide by 100) before multiplying.

Q: Method — percentage of a time period: What percentage of a day is 10 hours?

A: A day = 24 hours. $10/24 \times 100 = 41.67\%$.

Q: Method — percentage of a fraction: What percent of $2/7$ is $1/35$?

A: Set up: $x\% \text{ of } (2/7) = 1/35 \rightarrow x/100 \times 2/7 = 1/35 \rightarrow x = (1/35) \times (7/2) \times 100 = (7/70) \times 100 = 10\%$.

Q: Method — sum of two independent percentage-of-number terms: Find the value of 28% of 450 + 45% of 280.

A: 28% of 450 = 126. 45% of 280 = 126. Sum = $126 + 126 = 252$. (A nice coincidence both terms equal 126 here — don't expect that in general, just add the two percentage values separately.)

Q: Method — percentage greater than 100% (the result is bigger than the original number): Find 280% of 3,940.

A: $280\% = 2.80$. $2.80 \times 3,940 = 11,032$. Percentages over 100% just mean the result is larger than the base number — the calculation method doesn't change.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. A mobile phone was sold for ₹10,200 after successive discounts of 15% and 20%. What was its original price?

- A. ₹14,500
- B. ₹15,000 ✓**
- C. ₹15,500
- D. ₹16,000

Explanation: $P \times 0.85 \times 0.80 = 10,200 \rightarrow P \times 0.68 = 10,200 \rightarrow P = 15,000$. [medium, authored]

2. An alloy is 25% tin and 35% lead, the rest is copper. Find the copper in 40 kg of the alloy.

- A. 10 kg
- B. 14 kg
- C. 16 kg ✓**
- D. 20 kg

Explanation: Copper % = $100 - 25 - 35 = 40\%$. 40% of 40 kg = 16 kg. [easy, authored]

3. If 35% of $y = 91$, find y .

- A. 230
- B. 250
- C. 260 ✓**

D. 240

Explanation: $y = 91 / 0.35 = 260$. [easy, authored]

4. Find 1.25% of 80 kg.

A. 1 kg ✓

B. 10 kg

C. 0.1 kg

D. 12.5 kg

Explanation: $1.25\% = 0.0125$. $0.0125 \times 80 = 1$ kg. [easy, authored]

5. What percentage of a day is 6 hours?

A. 20%

B. 25% ✓

C. 30%

D. 16.67%

Explanation: $6/24 \times 100 = 25\%$. [easy, authored]

6. What percent of $3/8$ is $3/40$?

A. 10%

B. 15%

C. 20% ✓

D. 12%

Explanation: $x\%$ of $(3/8) = 3/40$, so $x/100 = (3/40) \div (3/8) = (3/40) \times (8/3) = 1/5$, giving $x = 20\%$. [medium, authored]

7. Find the value of 32% of 350 + 18% of 200.

A. 148 ✓

B. 138

C. 150

D. 146

Explanation: 32% of 350 = 112. 18% of 200 = 36. Sum = 148. [medium, authored]

8. Find 320% of 2,500.

A. 7,500

B. 8,000 ✓

C. 8,500

D. 9,000

Explanation: $320\% = 3.2$. $3.2 \times 2,500 = 8,000$. [easy, authored]

9. A quantity is first increased by 20%, then decreased by 20%. What is the net percentage change?

A. No change

B. 4% decrease ✓

C. 4% increase

D. 20% decrease

Explanation: Net change after +20% then -20% is always a decrease of $(20 \times 20)/100 = 4\%$ — increasing and then decreasing by the same percentage never cancels out, because the second change applies to a different (larger) base. [hard, authored]

10. The price of an item increases from ₹250 to ₹300. What is the percentage increase?

A. 15%

B. 20% ✓

C. 25%

D. 30%

Explanation: Increase = 50. Percentage increase = $(50/250) \times 100 = 20\%$. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "Never Trust a Mirror" — Erin Hanson

READING MATERIAL

A poem arguing that mirrors only show surface appearance, not true self-worth. Real coaching-site evidence tests theme, symbolism, and a couple of figures of speech.

Q: Who wrote "Never Trust a Mirror", and what is its central theme?

A: Erin Hanson. Central theme: self-worth comes from within, not from outer appearance.

Q: What does the mirror symbolize in the poem?

A: Outer appearance and illusion — the mirror shows only surface reflection, not a person's true worth or character.

Q: What does "skin deep" mean, as used in the poem?

A: Superficial, or only outward — describing something that has no depth beyond physical appearance.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "The mirror always lies."

A: Personification — a mirror (an inanimate object) is given the human capacity to 'lie'.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "When your eyelids flutter."

A: Imagery — a vivid, visual sensory description.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Never Trust a Mirror" was written by:

- A. Maya Angelou
- B. Robert Frost
- C. Erin Hanson ✓**
- D. W.H. Davies

Explanation: Erin Hanson. [easy, web-research]

2. The main theme of the poem is:

- A. Physical beauty
- B. The truth in reflections
- C. Self-worth comes from within ✓**
- D. Dreams and goals

Explanation: Self-worth comes from within. [easy, web-research]

3. What does the mirror symbolize in the poem?

- A. Confidence
- B. Truth
- C. Outer appearance and illusion ✓**
- D. Technology

Explanation: Outer appearance and illusion. [medium, web-research]

4. "The mirror always lies" uses which figure of speech?

- A. Simile
- B. Hyperbole
- C. Personification ✓**
- D. Irony

Explanation: Personification — the mirror given the human ability to 'lie'. [medium, web-research]

5. In the poem, "skin deep" means:

- A. Very deep
- B. Superficial or only outward ✓**
- C. Emotionally strong
- D. Spiritually rich

Explanation: Superficial/only outward. [medium, web-research]

6. "When your eyelids flutter" is an example of which poetic device?

A. Metaphor

B. Alliteration

C. Imagery ✓

D. Irony

Explanation: Imagery — vivid visual description. [medium, web-research]